

Yuheng Chen

Utrecht University • Biodiversity & Ecology Group • Department of Biology • Padualaan 8, 3584CH

+31 6 59 31 77 30 • y.chen3@uu.nl • <https://www.linkedin.com/in/yuheng-chen-923b5a111/>

Education

Utrecht University PhD Candidate in Ecology	2022-2027 Utrecht, Netherlands
Nanjing Forestry University Master of Science (MSc) in Ecology	2019-2022 Nanjing, China
Southwest Forestry University Bachelor of Science (BSc) in Forestry	2015-2019 Kunming, China

Publications

Chen, Y.; Hautier, Y.; Wright, A.J.; de Boer, H.; Lankhorst, J.; Odé, A.; Lube, V.V.; Kowalchuk, G.A.; Barry, K.E. **2026**. Above- and belowground plant functional composition drives the response of mixture biomass to air and soil drought. *Journal of Ecology*, under review.

Chen, Y.; Lembrechts, J.J.; Hautier, Y.; Xu, D.; Li, Y.; Dong, Y.; Mao, L. **2025**. Identifying divergence time and paleoclimate change hotspots for better conservation under future climate change. *Biological Conservation*, 312: 111499. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.biocon.2025.111499>

Chen, Y.; Hautier, Y.; Kowalchuk, G.A.; Barry, K.E. **2025**. 'Slow-Fast' plant trait spectra are associated with ecological niches across global climatic gradients. *Global Ecology and Biogeography*, 34: e70115. <https://doi.org/10.1111/geb.70115>

Chen, Y.; Li, Y.; Dong, Y.; Zhang, M.; Yang, Y.; Primack, R.; ... Mao, L. **2024**. More than just pandas: Urgent research needed on China's native plant biodiversity. *Biological Conservation*, 289: 110388. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.biocon.2023.110388>

Chen, Y.; Wu, Y.; Dong, Y.; Li, Y.; Ge, Z.; George, O.; ... Mao, L. **2023**. Extinction risk of Chinese angiosperms varies between woody and herbaceous species. *Diversity and Distributions*, 29: 232-243. <http://doi.org/10.1111/ddi.13655>

Chen, Y., Li, Y., Mao, L. **2022**. Combining the effects of global warming, land use change and dispersal limitations to predict the future distributions of East Asian Cerris oaks (*Quercus* section *Cerris*, Fagaceae) in China. *Forests*, 13: 367. <https://doi.org/10.3390/f13030367>

Xie, L.; Ou, Y.; **Chen, Y.**; Ding, H.; Fang, Y. **2025**. Parallel yet asymmetric community assembly patterns of phyllosphere fungi and bacteria in subtropical forests. *Forest Ecology and Management*, 598: 123222. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.foreco.2025.123222>

Li, X.; Song, Z.; Hu, Y.; Qiao, J.; **Chen, Y.**; Wang, S.; ... Zuo, X. **2024**. Drought intensity and post-drought precipitation determine vegetation recovery in a desert steppe in Inner Mongolia, China. *Science of The Total Environment*, 906: 167449. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.scitotenv.2023.167449>

Wang, X.; Morin, X.; Zhang, J.; Chen, G.; Mao, L.; **Chen, Y.**; ... Ma, K. **2023**. Geographical patterns and determinants in plant reproductive phenology duration. *Frontiers in Plant Science*, 14: 1199316. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpls.2023.1199316>

Yang, N.; Li, X.; Liu, D.; Zhang, Y.; **Chen, Y.**; Wang, B.; ... Mao, L. **2022**. Diversity patterns and drivers of soil bacterial and fungal communities along elevational gradients in the Southern Himalayas, China. *Applied Soil Ecology*, 178: 104563. <http://doi.org/10.1016/j.apsoil.2022.104563>

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Lu, S.; Zhou, S.; Yin, X.; Zhang, C.; Li, R.; Chen, J.; ... **Chen, Y. 2021.** Patterns of tree species richness in Southwest China. *Environmental Monitoring and Assessment*, 193: 1-13. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10661-021-08872-y>

Research Projects

PhD Thesis Project

How biodiversity ameliorate soil microenvironment from climate change in grasslands?

We use a combination of approaches, including a global database study, meta-analyses and large-scale experiments, to investigate the impact of biodiversity and drought stress on root traits and the soil microenvironment, as well as their impact on ecosystem productivity and stability.

MSc Thesis Project

Influencing factors and conservation measures of the extinction risk of angiosperms in China

We completed the key steps of identifying and protecting endangered species, that is, how to determine and quantify the relationship between phylogeny, functional traits, environmental threats, human activities and the threatened levels of endangered species.

Conference Presentations

Netherlands Annual Ecology Meeting 2026 (Poster)

Impacts of plant richness on soil nutrient availability and leaching

11/2/2026

British Ecological Society Annual Meeting 2024 (Oral)

Polycultures can better resist air and soil drought through functional traits

11/12/2024

Lysimeter & Ecotron Workshop 2024 (Oral)

Using Ecotrons to separate the effects of above and belowground drought

19/3/2024

Teaching

Bachelor's Course

Teaching assistant

Ecology 2

2023 - Now

Supervision

Bachelor Students

Timo Broekhoven (7.9/10); Puck Collignon (7.8/10); Jelmer de Groot (6.8/10); Britt Floris (8.5/10)

Master Students

Major-Project (Nine months): Caroline Karnay (8.5/10)

Writing assignment (Three months): Beier Hu (8.5/10)

Mini-Project (One month): Tilda Tarrant (9/10)